
MEETING MINUTES

April 8, 2024

Executive Session 6:00 PM

Regular Meeting: 7:00 PM

Agenda

- I. Roll Call for Attendance of Members and Student Representatives - 7/0
- II. Salute the Flag
- III. Executive Session

Executive session pursuant to G.L. c. 30A (a) (3): the Medford School Committee will convene in Executive Session to discuss strategy in preparation for negotiations with **Medford Educational Secretaries (AFSCME Council 93), Teamsters Local 25 Custodians, Medford Teachers Association for Kids Corner, Medford Teachers Association for Paraprofessionals, Carpenters (SEIU Local 888)** because an open meeting will have a detrimental effect on the bargaining position of the Committee and the Chair so declares.

Motion to enter into Executive Session by Member Reinfeld, second by Member Branley - 7/0 passes

Enter Executive Session at 5:07pm

Regular Meeting reconvened at 6:01 p.m.

- IV. Good of the Order - None
- V. Consent Agenda
 - Bills and Payrolls
 - Regular School Committee Minutes, **March 18, 2024**
 - Student Advisory Council Minutes, **March 20, 2024**
 - Strategic and Capital Planning Subcommittee Minutes, **March 26, 2024**
 - Committee of the Whole Meeting, **April 3, 2024**

Motion to approve by Member Ruseau as amended by Member Reinfeld on abstain voting recording on March 18, 2024 - 7/0 passes

- VI. Report of Subcommittees - None
- VII. Report of the Superintendent
 1. **Superintendent's Updates and Comments** - Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Superintendent

The Superintendent announced and congratulated Assistant Superintendent Suzanne Galusi on achieving her doctorate - **Congratulations Dr. Galusi!**

2. **Recommendation to Approve** a \$3,180.11 Donation from the Medford Educational Foundation.

Motion to approve with gratitude by Member Reinfeld, second by Member Graham - 7/0 passes

3. **Recommendation to Approve** a \$500 Donation from the Medford Rotary Club to the Media Technology Program.

Motion to approve with gratitude by Member Intoppa, second by Reinfeld - 7/0 passes

4. **Recommendation to Approve** a \$500 Donation from the Medford Kiwanis Club to the Culinary Arts Program.

Motion to approve with gratitude by Member Graham, second by Member Intoppa - 6/0/1 abstain

5. **Substitute Pay Report** - Dr. Susan B. Galusi, Assistant Superintendent of Academics & Instruction

Presentations of the Public (not to begin before 7:00 pm) - None

VIII. Continued Business - None

IX. New Business

2024 - 17 Offered by Member Intoppa

Recognition of Autism Acceptance Month

Whereas Autism Acceptance Month is recognized in the Month of April; and

Whereas Autism Acceptance Day is recognized on the second of April;

Now, therefore, be it

Resolved, that the Medford Public Schools and Medford School Committee:

1. Recognize Autism Acceptance Month within the Medford Public Schools System;
2. Recognize for future usage Autism Acceptance Day as April 2 on all official Medford Public Schools Calendars distributed to the public; and
3. Report to the Medford School Committee on steps being taken with the Medford Public Schools to support students impacted by Autism Spectrum Disorder (ASD) and how we go about identifying students who may need these services that have yet to receive them.

Explanation:

Those within and advocates of the autism spectrum community are looking to distance themselves from groups that treat autism as a disease and something that “needs to be healed”. The focus is not on awareness of Autism Spectrum Disorder (ASD), but more of a focus on acceptance of the members of our community that fall under the autism spectrum and making sure there are equitable systematic pathways for their success. Being conscious of decisions that may impact members of the ASD community, both systematically and socially. This is the first step in this process to better understand and see how we as a City can better serve our community members impacted by ASD.

Date Submitted: 4/3/2024

Date Requested to be on the Agenda: 4/8/2024

Motion to approve as amended on #2* and to move to Behavioral Health subcommittee for further review by Member Intoppa, second by Member Branley - 6/1 passes

*#2: Observe Autism Acceptance Month as April 2nd on published calendars where days are listed naturally

#3 Report to the school committee on steps being taken by the schools to provide support for those impacted by Autism Spectrum Disorder and to strike the second half of number 3.
Recommended to bring for review to SEPAC by Member Reinfeld and to the Behavioral Health Subcommittee by Member Graham

Motion to approve as amended and move to subcommittee on #3 by Member Intoppa, second by Member Branley - 6/1 passes (technical difficulties for absentee)

2024-18 Offered by Member Graham

Be it resolved that the Medford School Committee will adopt the following revised subcommittee structure for this term.

	Behavioral Health & Special Education	Buildings & Grounds	Curriculum, Instruction, Assessment & Accountability	Diversity Equity & Inclusion	Family Engagement & Communication	Rules & Policy	Strategic & Capital Planning	Superintendent Evaluation	Ad Hoc Committee Handbook Eval Process
Chair	Paul Ruseau	Nicole Branley	Erika Reinfeld	Aaron Olapade	Jenny Graham	Paul Ruseau	Jenny Graham	Aaron Olapade	Paul Ruseau
Member 1	Aaron Olapade	Paul Ruseau	Nicole Branley	Paul Ruseau	John Intoppa	Jenny Graham	Paul Ruseau	Nicole Branley	Erika Reinfeld
Member 2	John Intoppa	Aaron Olapade	Paul Ruseau	Erika Reinfeld	Erika Reinfeld	Nicole Branley	Erika Reinfeld	John Intoppa	John Intoppa

Motion to approve by Member Ruseau, second by Mayor Lungo-Koehn - 7/0 passes

2024-19 Offered by Member Graham

MSBA Update

Recommendation to appoint the School Building Committee - Presented by Member Graham

Date Submitted: 4/3/2024

Date Requested to be on the Agenda: 4/8/2024

- Member Graham shared a slide presentation to update the committee.
- Details on the applicants that applied to be on the committee and who was selected
 - Recommended committee: Member Olapade, Emily Lazarro, Nicole Morell, Libby Brown, Maria D'Orsi, Brain Hilliard, Tracy Keene, Marissa Desmond, Luke Preisner
 - Non-voting member - Member Ruseau
 - Committee is subject to approval by MSBA so there could be changes
 - These members will be trained in operating ground rules

Motion to approve voting members by Member Reinfeld, second by Member Branley - 7/0 passes

Anthony Geehan

MTA Union President and High School Teacher

45 Elm Hill Avenue, Leominster, MA

Applauds Maria D'Orsi being recommended, would like to see more teachers for day to day operation questions and vocational representation or an advisory committee be set up.

Member Graham stated the MSBA has very specific rules and makes final decisions on who and how the committees are set up. There will be a much broader inclusion when we get further into the process. Anyone can reach out to Member Graham with questions and all meetings will be publicly held for input.

Motion to approve committee members by Member Reinfeld, second by Member Branley - 7/0

Motion by Member Graham as amended by Mayor Lungo-Koehn with 2 more community or staff non voting members added to the committee by Mayor Lungo-Koehn, second by Member Graham - 7/0 passes

X. Reports Requested

Revised School Handbooks: As requested, handbooks for all schools are respectfully submitted for review by the Ad Hoc Committee.

Brooks Elementary

Missituk Elementary

McGlynn Elementary

Roberts Elementary

Andrews Middle School (working draft)

McGlynn Middle School

Medford High School/Vocational Technical/Curtis Tufts

(final draft to be submitted on May 6, 2024)

Member Branley - raised the question of why all elementary can't be in one handbook, one for middle and one for high school level. All rules in the same grade level should be the same.

The Superintendent mentioned that there are slight differences but most at the same grade level are the same in content. All schools are required to have their own book.

Motion to approve with final handbooks to be presented on May 6, 2024 by Member Intoppa, second by Member Reinfeld - 7/0 passes

Suspension and Discipline Report - A draft of the District-wide Suspension and Discipline Report has been provided to the members for review and feedback. The final report will be presented at the April 29, 2024 meeting.

Motion to approve final report on April 29, 2024 by Member Reinfeld, second by Member Intoppa - 7/0 passes

XI. Condolences

The Members of the Medford School Committee express their sincerest condolences to the family of **Gladys Gomez**, grandmother of Breanna Martignetti, nurse at the Roberts Elementary School.

The Members of the Medford School Committee express their sincerest condolences to the family of **Prudence (Penny) Muollo**, an elementary teacher in Medford for over 30 years.

XII. Next Meeting

April 24, 2024 - Special Meeting via Zoom at 5:00 pm

April 29, 2024 - Regular Meeting, Alden Memorial Chambers, Medford City Hall in addition to Zoom

XIII. Adjournment

Motion to adjourn by Member Ruseau, second by Member Reinfeld - 7/0 passes
Meeting adjourned 7:57 p.m.